

# A) About: PBI VC App

## Table of Contents

- [Table of Contents](#)
- [INTRODUCTION](#)
  - [All Pages](#)
- [SOLUTION OVERVIEW](#)
  - [Summary](#)
  - [Risks of No Version Control](#)
  - [Benefits of PBI VC App](#)
  - [VC Resources](#)
  - [VC Workspaces](#)
- [VC App Interface](#)
  - [Home Page](#)
  - [Instructional Video](#)
- [Appendix](#)
  - [PBI VC newest published files \(PowerShell\)](#)

### Version History

| Date        | Version | Description                                         | Author       |
|-------------|---------|-----------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| 09/14 /2023 | 1.0     | Initial document                                    | Brian Lofton |
| 10/5 /2023  | 2.0     | Moved some sections to 'How to Use PBI VC App' page | Brian Lofton |
| 10/12 /2023 | 2.1     | Moved some sections to 'Installs' page              | Brian Lofton |

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## INTRODUCTION

The moment we've all been waiting for! The perfect solution for working on PBIX files and collaborating with multiple Power BI developers! And now Excel files, too!

This page offers an overview description of the PBI VC App, the benefits, and solution components.

### All Pages

- [A\) About: PBI VC App](#)
- [B\) User Guide: PBI VC App](#)
- [C\) PBI: SharePoint Upload PBIX \(Workspace Automatic sync\)](#)
- [D\) Demo Functionality](#)
- [Install: HCDW New PBI VC Project](#)

[More...](#) [Less...](#)

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## SOLUTION OVERVIEW

### Summary

The Power BI Version Control solution is an open-source solution, fully in the Power Platform (power apps) and SharePoint environment (document library).

It lets users apply version control and local editing for PBIX or PBIT files, and provides the ability to easily implement version control for their Power BI projects.

### Risks of No Version Control

- With no Version Control process, Power BI developers cannot effectively collaborate their development efforts with no versioning system.
- There is a risk of mismanaging versions, and causing inaccurate reports or user experience issues.
- Productivity will be hindered with no versioning system
- Time and Productivity issues can rise from having no versioning systems, as follows:
  - 1) Developers may be required to troubleshoot issues related to file mismanagement and releasing bugs,
  - 2) Developers may spend extra time locating colleagues sources files for support & development

## Benefits of PBI VC App

The Power BI Version Control enables version control and local editing for PBIX or PBIT files. The solution is fully in the Power Platform (power apps) and SharePoint environment (document library). Productivity increases with streamlined process.

Using the PBI VC solution provides a quick and simple method to implement version control on PBI files (and Excel). Developers will always be on the most current/valid code file, and check-out will ensure only changes can be made by only one person. The PBI VC solution contains intuitive interface that encourages check-in comments. Colleagues can collaborate effectively and understand changes that are published.

- **Single shared location for reports** – Keep all versions of the report
- **Ability to check out file** – Only one person can make changes at a time; no collaboration collisions
- **Ability to check in files** – Add comments on changes
- **Work locally** – Make all changes to the local copies
  - The main branch file is edited only when desired instead of every single time the file is saved!!!
  - Do you want to test something out and keep the main file safe? This is the way!!!
- **PBI Workplace deployment automatic (optional configuration)** – SharePoint files can be synced directly with the PBI Workspace. What's that mean? When files are checked in the updates will be reflected directly into the PBI workspace! No more pressing the "Publish" button in PBI Desktop. No more worrying about selecting the correct workspace name when deploying!

## VC Resources

| Links                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Activities                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Power Apps (PBI Version Control App - Demo)</b><br><br>This is connected to "Demo" repository. Read below for working on reports in the Project folders live environment. PBI VC app is how files will be edited.<br><br>Link:<br><br><a href="#">PBI VC: VC Demo Folder</a>                                                      | <b>Front-end application for version control</b><br><br>1. Check out reports (File pulled locally to GFE, from SharePoint sync folder)<br>2. Check in reports (with developer comments!)<br>3. Reports are automatically published to TEST workspace (*) |
| <b>Sharepoint Site Documents (HCDW PBI Reporting - Demo)</b><br><br>New reports will be added directly here. This is the only time a file will be modified via SharePoint page directly. PBI VC process is how files will be edited after initial upload.<br><br>Link:<br><br><a href="#">SharePoint: Document Libraries Browser</a> | <b>Back-end file management</b><br><br>1. View version history (with developer comments!)<br>2. Restore file version                                                                                                                                     |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |

\* [Automated Sync Deployment](#): Optional configuration in Power BI for DEV environment workspace (discuss option with your PBI Administrators /Developers). Production reports deployments will be manually performed by PBI Admin.

## VC Workspaces



### PBI Workspaces

When a new workspace is created, a new VC App must be created. These steps are documented in the Team Training pages.

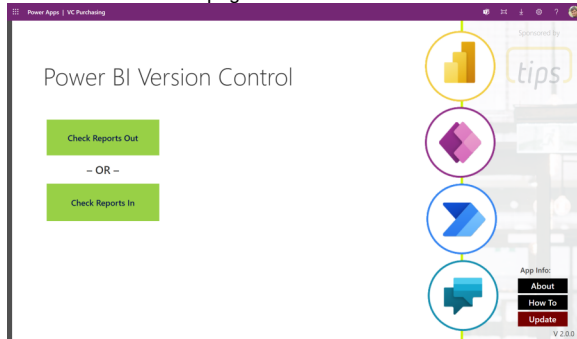
At VA HCDW each workspace contains an individual Version Control App (link) for developing report files.

# VC App Interface

 These are the basic screens and steps involved for developing the PBIX report files.

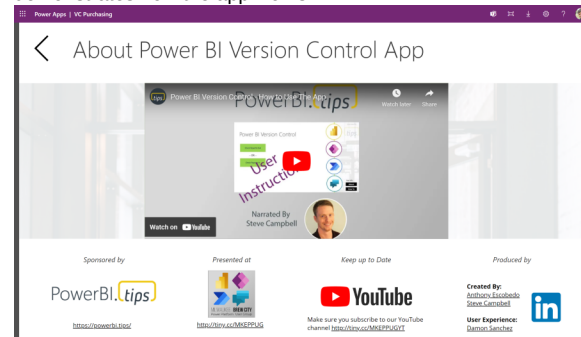
## Home Page

This is what the home page looks like.



## Instructional Video

The app has a built-in instructional video you can watch that demonstrates how the app works.



## Appendix

### PBI VC newest published files (PowerShell)

We can run a PowerShell script to list the 10 most recently modified files, with report name and date modified.

Power BI Reports Site - HCDW Team Training\PBI\6. PBI VC App\PBIVC\_newest-published-files.ps1

```
FOLDER ...
C:\Users\VHAF\loft08\Department of Veterans Affairs\Power BI Reports Site - VC Demo\Published Reports
C:\Users\VHAF\loft08\Department of Veterans Affairs\Power BI Reports Site - VC HCDW Sandbox\Published Reports
C:\Users\VHAF\loft08\Department of Veterans Affairs\Power BI Reports Site - VC HCDW TDD Models\Published Reports
C:\Users\VHAF\loft08\Department of Veterans Affairs\Power BI Reports Site - VC HCDW Team\Published Reports
C:\Users\VHAF\loft08\Department of Veterans Affairs\Power BI Reports Site - VC Payroll\Published Reports
FILES LATEST CHANGES ...
Press any key to continue...
FileName                               LastWriteTime          Directory
-----
Report Template.pbix                   10/3/2023 10:53:53 AM   \Power BI Reports Site - VC HCDW Team\Published Reports
SAMPLE PBIX - Sales & Returns Sample.pbix 10/3/2023 10:52:51 AM   \Power BI Reports Site - VC HCDW Sandbox\Published Reports
PBI-Cleaner-Gen2-V7.pbix                10/3/2023 10:50:07 AM   \Power BI Reports Site - VC HCDW TDD Models\Published Reports
MyReport_Test.pbix                     10/3/2023 10:17:37 AM   \Power BI Reports Site - VC Demo\Published Reports
COLUMN CLEANER - VA Time to Hire Dashboard.pbix 10/2/2023 8:44:36 AM   \Power BI Reports Site - VC HCDW TDD Models\Published Reports
SAMPLE PBIX - Retail Analysis.pbix      9/22/2023 2:56:34 PM   \Power BI Reports Site - VC HCDW Sandbox\Published Reports
AWS-RED (conn-test).pbix               9/22/2023 2:18:57 PM   \Power BI Reports Site - VC Demo\Published Reports
FIELD FINDER - VA Time to Hire Dashboard.pbix 9/20/2023 8:12:57 AM   \Power BI Reports Site - VC HCDW TDD Models\Published Reports
Power BI Field Finder.pbix              9/19/2023 9:16:58 AM   \Power BI Reports Site - VC HCDW TDD Models\Published Reports
Very Basics of Power BI Row Level Security.pbix 9/14/2023 10:01:40 AM   \Power BI Reports Site - VC HCDW Team\Published Reports
```

```

<#-----
PBI VC newest published files
* List of files all checked out to a yer
-----#>

$BaseDir = "C:\Users\
$NameToFind = "Published Reports"

$MyVariable_Folders = Get-ChildItem $BaseDir -Recurse | Where-Object { $_.PSIsContainer -and $_.Name.EndsWith($NameToFind)}
$MyVariable_Files = Get-ChildItem $BaseDir -Recurse -File | Where-Object { $_.PSPath.Contains($NameToFind)}

Write-Host "FOLDER ... " -ForegroundColor Cyan
$MyVariable_Folders.FullName

Write-Host "FILES LATEST CHANGES ... " -ForegroundColor Cyan
$MyVariable_Files | select @{Name = 'FileName'; Expression = {$_ .Name.Substring(0, [Math]::Min($_.Name.Length, 60))}} `
, LastWriteTime, @{Name = 'Directory'; Expression = {$_ .DirectoryName.Replace($BaseDir, '')}} |
SORT @{Expression="LastWriteTime";Descending=$true} | SELECT -first 10

Write-Host "Press any key to continue..."
$Host.UI.RawUI.ReadKey("NoEcho,IncludeKeyDown")

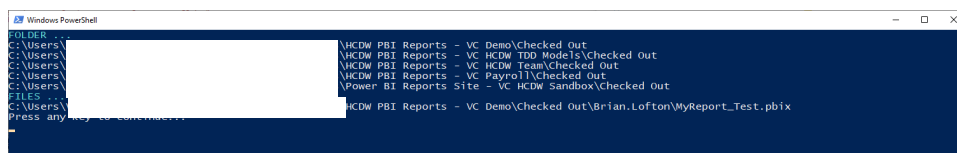
```

## All Files Checked Out (PowerShell)

The VC App contains a screen showing all files checked out within the project VC app.

We can also use a PowerShell script to list all checked out files.

Power BI Reports Site - HCDW Team Training\PBI\6. PBI VC App\PBIVC\_checked-out-list.ps1



```

Windows PowerShell
FOLDER ...
C:\Users\... HCDW PBI Reports - VC Demo\checked out
C:\Users\... HCDW PBI Reports - VC HCDW TDD Models\checked out
C:\Users\... HCDW PBI Reports - VC HCDW Team\checked out
C:\Users\... HCDW PBI Reports - VC Payroll\checked out
C:\Users\... Power BI Reports Site - VC HCDW sandbox\checked out
FILES ...
C:\Users\... HCDW PBI Reports - VC Demo\checked out\Brian.Lofton\MyReport_Test.pbix
Press any key to continue...

```

```
<#-----
PBI VC checked out list
* List of files all checked out to a yer
-----#>

$BaseDir = "C:\Users\
$NameToFind = "Checked Out"

$MyVariable_Folders = Get-ChildItem $BaseDir -Recurse | Where-Object { $_.PSIsContainer -and $_.Name.
EndsWith($NameToFind)}
$MyVariable_Files = Get-ChildItem $BaseDir -Recurse -File | Where-Object { $_.PSPath.Contains($NameToFind)}

Write-Host "FOLDER ... " -ForegroundColor Cyan
$MyVariable_Folders.FullName
Write-Host "FILES ... " -ForegroundColor Cyan
$MyVariable_Files.FullName
```

# B) User Guide: PBI VC App

## Table of Contents

- [Table of Contents](#)
- [INTRODUCTION](#)
  - [All Pages](#)
- [INSTRUCTIONS](#)
  - [What does this app do?](#)
  - [PBI Versioning Developer Workflow](#)
- [SCREENSHOTS](#)
  - [In-App Video](#)
  - [Sync Libraries: Local Files](#)
  - [SharePoint Document Library](#)
  - [PBI Versioning - Demo Folder](#)
  - [PBI Versioning - HCDW Team](#)
  - [PBI Versioning - HCDW TDD Models](#)
  - [PBI Versioning - HCDW Sandbox](#)
  - [PBI Versioning - HCDW Payroll](#)
- [APPENDIX](#)
  - [Deployments \(Another Scope\)](#)
  - [Automatic Sync \(PBI Workspace\)](#)

### Version History

| Date       | Version | Description      | Author       |
|------------|---------|------------------|--------------|
| 09/28/2023 | 1.0     | Initial document | Brian Lofton |

## INTRODUCTION

This article describes the initial setup, the screens you will work with, and steps performed to use the VC App for versioning your PBI files.

- [Pre-Req Setup](#)
- [PBI Versioning](#)
- [SharePoint Libraries Page](#)

### All Pages

- [A\) About: PBI VC App](#)
- [B\) User Guide: PBI VC App](#)
- [C\) PBI: SharePoint Upload PBIX \(Workspace Automatic sync\)](#)
- [D\) Demo Functionality](#)
- [Install: HCDW New PBI VC Project](#)

[More...](#) [Less...](#)

## INSTRUCTIONS



### Getting Started

There are a few pages, but it is very simple and quick once you perform the workflow a couple time and understand the workflow.

### What does this app do?

The app automates some activities in SharePoint folder where PBIX files are saved. The activities can be done manually, but the app simplifies and streamlines the process, enabling developers to collaborate effectively.

| CHECK OUT: All of these steps happen with check out action.                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ACTIONS                                                                                                       | WHAT THIS MEANS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| 1) Moves the file from "Published" to "User" folder ( <b>My Report.pbix</b> ), and is checked out to the user | Version history is only kept with the "Checked Out" file. The developer will use Windows file explorer local sync copy, to modify the "Check Out" user file. <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>This file will eventually be moved back to "Published" folder during Check In step, either by CHECK IN or DISCARD changes.</li> </ul> |
| 2) A "Published" file copy is created ( <b>My Report1.pbix</b> ), and is also checked out                     | The copy file name ending with "1", is temporary to show other users that this Published file is checked out to another user. <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>This file will eventually be deleted during Check In step, and the main file is restored in the "Published" folder.</li> </ul>                                       |

| CHECK IN: All of these steps happen with check in action.  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ACTIONS                                                    | WHAT THIS MEANS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| 1) Moves the files from "User" to "Published" folder       | At the Check In screen, the developer chooses either CHECK IN or DISCARD changes: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li><b>CHECK IN:</b> All changes the developers has made are rolled up into one commit with version comment to the "Published" file</li> <li><b>DISCARD:</b> The SharePoint discard action is applied to the file, and this removes all changes the developers has made since checking out the file. The "Published" file remains at its previous state with all history at the time of check out.</li> </ul> |
| 2) Delete the file from "User" folder                      | The SharePoint move action will remove the "User" file, as it is moved back to "Published"                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 3) The "Published" file is updated                         | The "Published" file is restored (discarded) or updated (check in). This updated the main source file.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 4) The "Main" file is checked in, with user comments added | If you have selected CHECK IN, and entered a comment, all of that information is published to the "Published" file.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |

## PBI Versioning Developer Workflow

### Pre-Req Setup



#### Initial Setup

The Pre-Req setups tasks are only needed the first time you get started with the PBI VC App. These setup tasks only take a few minutes to complete.

| #  | Step                                                                                                                                  |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>You must first sync the SharePoint library for the PBI VC repositories</li> </ul>              |
| 2. | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>It's also helpful to Bookmark the app page url on your browser (Chrome, Edge, etc.)</li> </ul> |

### PBI App Link

This page is very convenient for accessing VC App links, and browsing all PBI versioned files.

| Link                                            | Source     | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-------------------------------------------------|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <a href="#">view Document Libraries Browser</a> | SharePoint | <p>In order to use the PBI VC files, you must first sync the SharePoint library for the PBI VC repositories.</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• <b>Published Reports:</b> The files in this folder are published to Development workspace</li> <li>• <b>Checked Out:</b> The files in this folder are being worked on by a developer</li> <li>• <b>Decommission:</b> These files are no longer needed and have been removed from Published</li> </ul> |

### **PBI Versioning**

| #  | Step                                                           | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|----|----------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. | <b>Navigate to the PBI VC App page url</b>                     | Each workspace has its own VC App; That is where you will the report                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 2. | <b>Check out report</b>                                        | (PBI VC app screen)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 3. | <b>Open the file from SharePoint Sync ("Check Out" folder)</b> | Your own folder is located within "Checked Out" containing the files you check out                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| 4. | <b>Work on the file locally</b>                                | <p>Edit the PBIX file on your GFE or other computer. Save the file.</p> <p>BEFORE Checking, WAIT for sync complete (green check icon).</p> <p>If you perform the Check In function during sync pending (blue refresh icon), before the sync is complete (green check icon), the file will be checked in to "Published" folder before the changes are uploaded to the on line file, causing some issues with getting the file changes applied correctly.</p> |
| 5. | <b>Check in reports, with developer comments!</b>              | (PBI VC app screen)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 6. | <b>Reports are automatically published to DEV workspace</b>    | <p>Using the <a href="#">PBI Workspace: SharePoint Upload PBIX</a> method to upload, the SharePoint file changes will automatically show up in the PBI Workspace.</p> <p>This eliminates the need to "Publish" the report in Power BI Desktop.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                          |

### **SharePoint Libraries Page**

Here are the activities completed using the document library in SharePoint online–

| #  | Step                                                  | Description                                                          |
|----|-------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. | <b>View version history, with developer comments!</b> | Each workspace has its own VC App; That is where you will the report |
| 2. | <b>Restore file version</b>                           |                                                                      |

## SCREENSHOTS

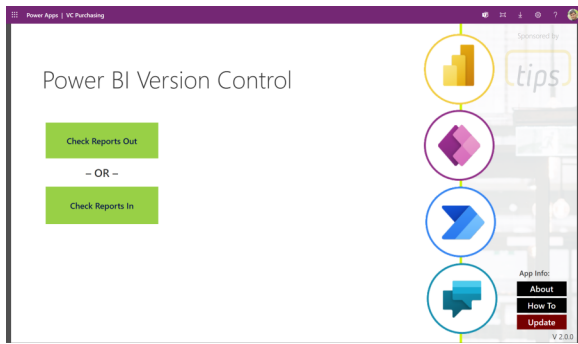
### **In-App Video**

Navigate to "Home Page | About", and to see the video.

Video:

*The in-app video page that provides simple and clear instructions of using the app and the workflow.*





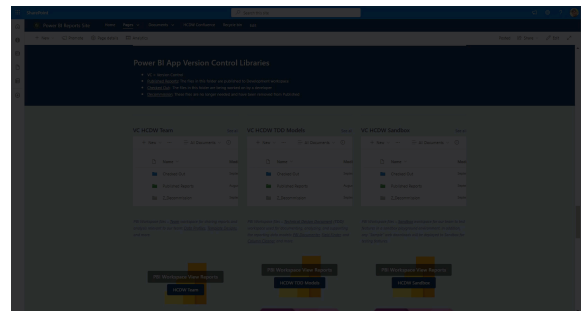
## Sync Libraries: Local Files

In order to use the PBI VC files, you must first sync the SharePoint library for the PBI VC repositories.

1. [SharePoint: Document Libraries Browser](#)
2. Click the ellipse (...) > Sync
3. Verify the folder are synced locally
  - a. Open file explorer > Expand 'Department of Veteran Affairs'
  - b. It is the folder with the blue business building icon

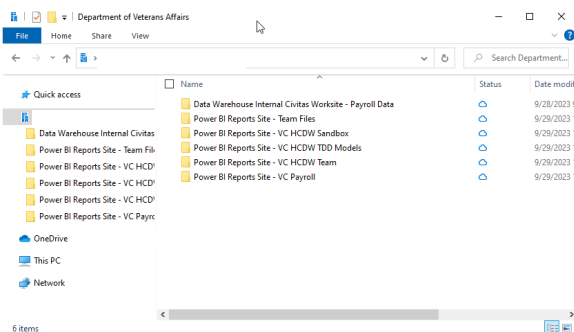
## GIF Screenshot Examples

The GIF demonstrates the steps to sync the files locally for the first time.



## File Explorer: SharePoint Local Files Sync Location

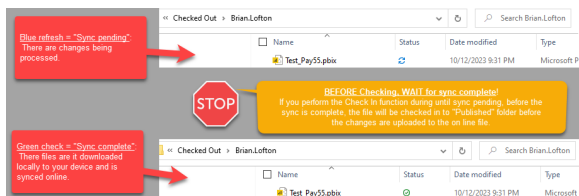
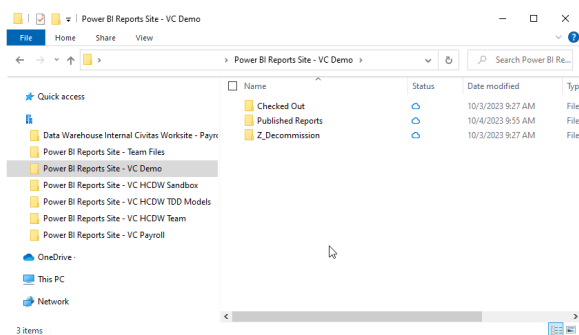
C:\Users\%username%\



## Screenshot Examples

This is a screenshot of the SharePoint page, *Document Libraries Browser & PBI VC App Libraries*.





## SharePoint Document Library

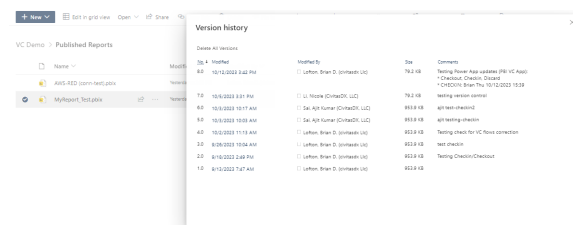
Here are the activities completed using the document library in SharePoint online–

1. View version history, with developer comments!
2. Restore file version

Document Library Links:

This page allows for quickly accessing all version control repositories and browsing all files in the back-end repository in SharePoint.

## Screenshot Examples



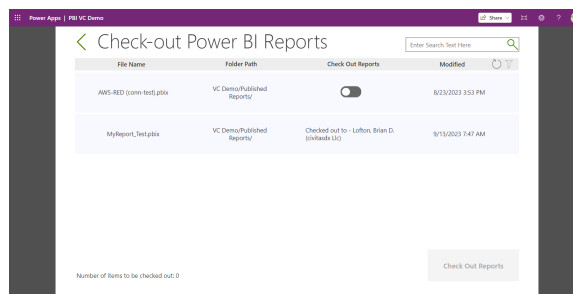
## PBI Versioning - Demo Folder

This is connected to "Demo" repository. Individual Project folders will be created for working on live reports in our environment.

App Link:

VC App: [Demo Folder](#)

- ✓ **TESTED:** On '9/22/2023', file successfully checked out/in for user Brian Lofton -- 'AWS-RED (conn-test).pbix'



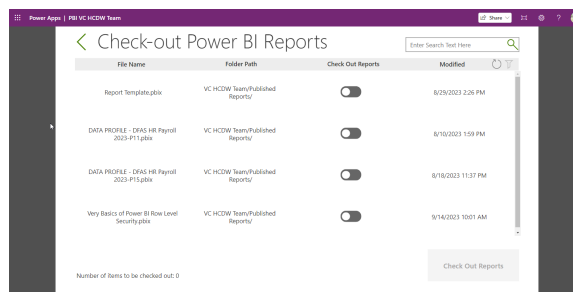
## PBI Versioning - HCDW Team

1. Check out reports
2. Work on the file locally
3. Check in reports, with developer comments!
4. Reports are automatically published to DEV workspace

App Link:

VC App: [HCDW Team](#)

- ✓ **TESTED:** On '9/22/2023', file successfully checked out/in for user Brian Lofton -- 'Report Template.pbix'



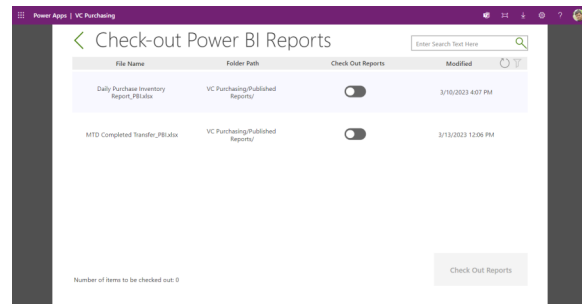
## PBI Versioning - HCDW TDD Models

1. Check out reports
2. Work on the file locally
3. Check in reports, with developer comments!
4. Reports are automatically published to DEV workspace

App Link:

VC App: [HCDW TDD Models](#)

- ☒ **TESTED:** On '9/22/2023', file successfully checked out/in for Bri an Lofton -- 'PBI-Cleaner-Gen2-V7.pbix'



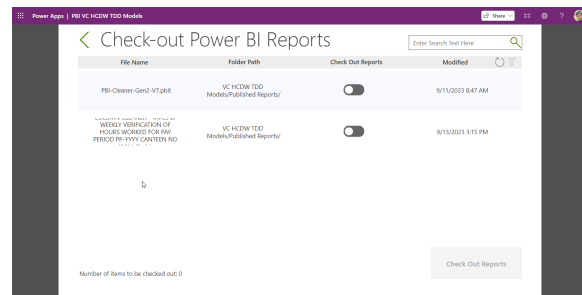
## PBI Versioning - HCDW Sandbox

1. Check out reports
2. Work on the file locally
3. Check in reports, with developer comments!
4. Reports are automatically published to DEV workspace

App Link:

VC App: [HCDW Sandbox](#)

- ☒ **TESTED:** On '9/22/2023', file successfully checked out/in for user Brian Lofton -- 'SAMPLE PBIX - Retail Analysis.pbix'
- ☐ **ERROR:** The following files have had errors: **Test\_Pay55.pbix**
- ☐ **Error Message: Power Apps Flow Details: Http request failed as there is an error: 'Cannot write more bytes to the buffer than the configured maximum buffer size: 104857600.'**
  - ☐



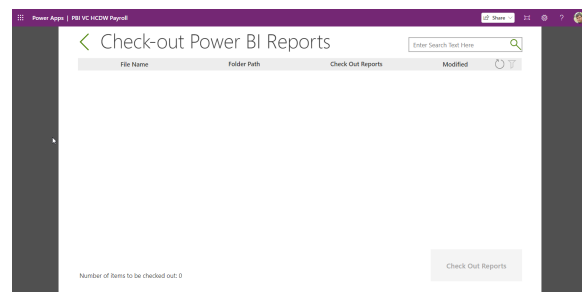
## PBI Versioning - HCDW Payroll

1. Check out reports
2. Work on the file locally
3. Check in reports, with developer comments!
4. Reports are automatically published to DEV workspace

App Link:

VC App: [HCDW Payroll](#)

- ☐ **TESTED:** On 'm/d', file successfully checked out/in for user -- 'file name'



## APPENDIX

### Deployments (Another Scope)

Moving these changes from DEV– through the deployment pipeline to TEST/PROD– is another scope of Power BI content management.

This articles discusses getting the reports into DEV workspace, with versioned file changes.

### Automatic Sync (PBI Workspace)

Using PBI Workspace method to upload the PBIX, the changes made to SharePoint file (in version control app) will automatically show up in the PBI Workspace.

| Link                                                                             | Source          | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <a href="#">configure PBI Workspace: SharePoint Upload PBIX (Automatic sync)</a> | HCDW Confluence | This article describes the PBI Workspace option to upload a SharePoint PBIX file. The Pros/Cons are explained, and the automatic sync process is explained. The HCDW developers will each review the "Pros/Cons" and become familiar with potential issues to avoid. |

# C) PBI: SharePoint Upload PBIX (Workspace Automatic sync)

## Table of Contents

- [Table of Contents](#)
- [INTRODUCTION](#)
  - [Overview](#)
  - [All Pages](#)
- [UPLOAD SHAREPOINT PBIX](#)
  - [Review: Pros and Cons of Upload SharePoint PBIX](#)
  - [Review: Workspaces](#)
  - [Process: Upload File \(One Time Only\)](#)
  - [Process: Verify Updates Published](#)
- [VIDEO LINKS](#)
  - [Syncing Published Power BI Report Files Using OneDrive | YouTube - Havens Consulting](#)
- [APPENDIX](#)

version history

| Date       | Version | Description        | Author       |
|------------|---------|--------------------|--------------|
| 09/12/2023 | 1.0     | Initial document   | Brian Lofton |
| 10/5/2023  | 2.0     | Completed document | Brian Lofton |

## INTRODUCTION

This article describes the PBI Workspace option to upload a SharePoint PBIX file. The Pros/Cons are explained, and the automatic sync process is explained.

The HCDW developers will each review the "Pros/Cons" and become familiar with potential issues to avoid.

The HCDW Team will adopt the "Upload PBIX SharePoint" file option in the workspaces, as the team's method for publishing reports to Power BI.

### Overview

Using PBI Workspace method to upload the PBIX, the changes made to SharePoint file (in version control app) will automatically show up in the PBI Workspace.

This eliminates the need to "Publish" the report in Power BI Desktop. Simply saving the file will get those changes made to the report in the PBI workspace.

### All Pages

- [A\) About: PBI VC App](#)
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- [Install: HCDW New PBI VC Project](#)

[More...](#) [Less...](#)

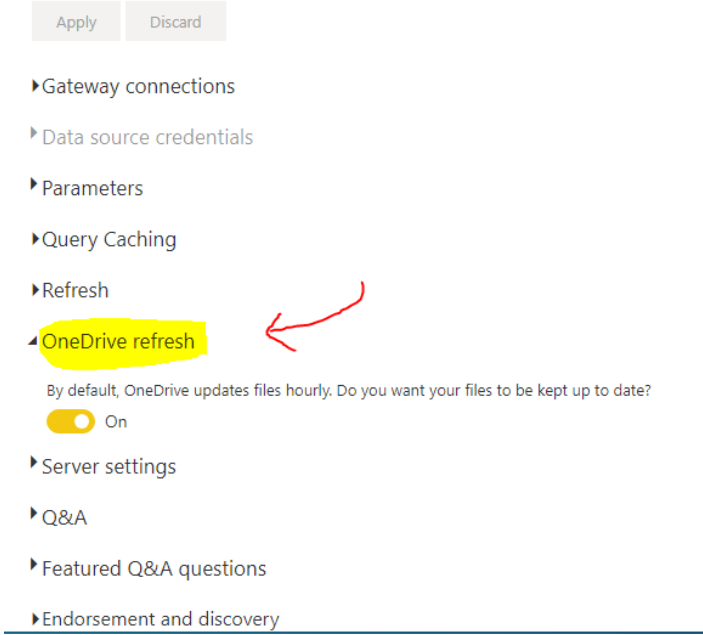
---

## UPLOAD SHAREPOINT PBIX

### Review: Pros and Cons of Upload SharePoint PBIX

The benefits outweigh the risks and known issues.

The HCDW Team will adopt the "Upload PBIX SharePoint" file option in the workspaces, as the team's method for publishing reports to Power BI.

| PROS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | CONS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>The team will always know which copy is the current version. The overall process is quick, smooth, and streamlined. You do not need to Published the report from Power BI Desktop; Simply Check-In the report and the work is done.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                          | <p>There are a couple nuances when using the Upload SharePoint option to publish reports. It is a difficult to know and confirm the exact location of where the file was uploaded from, and new reports must be added manually for the first time. These issues are low-risk and cause no harm to the deployment process.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <p><b><u>Developer Collaboration Transparency</u></b></p> <p>What you see in version control will always match the workspace. The source file is kept in Version Control location with history of changes, by who, and comments of the changes.</p> <p><b><u>Benefit</u></b></p> <p>There will never be any questions as to which file is the correct source file. The team will always know which copy is the current version.</p> | <p><b><u>SharePoint Connection Lineage</u></b> – [Risk Level]: LOW</p> <p>It is difficult to tell if a file is connected to SharePoint folder. But it is possible.</p> <p><b><u>Work Around</u></b></p> <p>To see if the report is connect to SharePoint-- "Workspace   Dataset   Settings   OneDrive". Look through the dataset settings (Gateway, Refresh, etc.), and if you see a "OneDrive" setting, this means the report is connect to an online location (SharePoint, OneDrive).</p>  <p>Apply Discard</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>▸ Gateway connections</li><li>▸ Data source credentials</li><li>▸ Parameters</li><li>▸ Query Caching</li><li>▸ Refresh</li><li>▸ OneDrive refresh</li></ul> <p>By default, OneDrive updates files hourly. Do you want your files to be kept up to date?</p> <p><input checked="" type="checkbox"/> On</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>▸ Server settings</li><li>▸ Q&amp;A</li><li>▸ Featured Q&amp;A questions</li><li>▸ Endorsement and discovery</li></ul> |

### Streamlined Process

Nothing further is needed after you check-in the report. The changes will be automatically synced into the Power BI workspace.

#### Benefit

The overall process is quick, smooth, and streamlined. There are hardly any technical concerns for collaborating and managing the Power BI report files.

#### Full Process

1. Navigate to the PBI VC App page url
2. Check out report
3. Open the file from SharePoint Sync ("Check Out" folder)
4. Work on the file locally
5. Check in reports, with developer comments!
6. Reports are automatically published to PBI workspace (within minutes)

### SharePoint Folder Lineage – [Risk Level]: LOW

There is no possible way to tell which exact SharePoint site and folder the file is connected to. Only that it is connected to an online location (SharePoint, OneDrive)

#### Work Around

If the team follows Best practice, and stores PBIX files where everyone knows where they are, then there should be no reason or need to see the file source connection lineage.

### PBI Desktop Publish Not needed

You do not need to Published the report from Power BI Desktop.

#### Benefit

Using the 'Publish' option requires you search and select the correct workspace. When searching to publish to the workspace, it is possible to select the incorrect workspace.

### BEFORE Checking, WAIT for sync complete – [Risk Level]: LOW

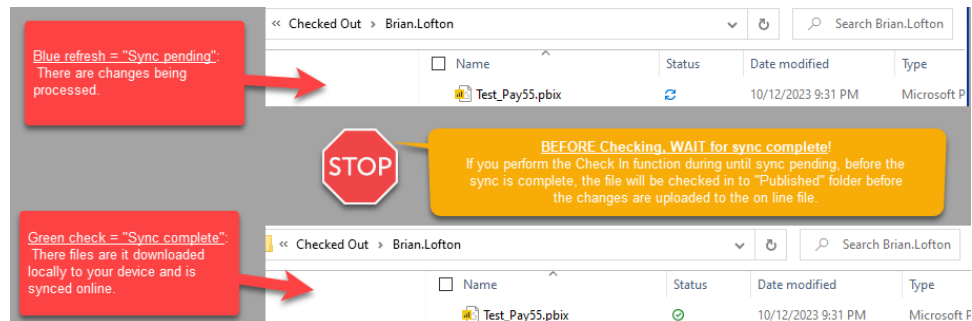
If you perform the Check In function during until sync pending (blue refresh icon), before the sync is complete (green check icon), the file will be checked in to "Published" folder before the changes are uploaded to the on line file. And once the sync does complete, there will be an extra file leftover in the "Checked Out" user folder, this file does include the changes.

#### Work Around

BEFORE Checking, WAIT for sync complete, and versioning will work just fine. If you do make this mistake, and Checkin while the file sync is pending, you can copy the extra file leftover in the "Checked Out" user folder to another location, then use PBI VC app to Checkout the file again, then copy the extra file back into the "Checked Out" user folder. Version history is retained, and all of the changes will be merged into the file. Now, try again... (wait for sync to complete and Checkin the file using the PBI VC app).

Low Risk:

This is classified as Low risk, because if this is not fixed and done correctly, changes made to the checked out file can be lost. And you will need to find that file in the SharePoint Recycle Bin to restore the file.



**ERROR: "Refresh failed .pbix OneDrive refresh disabled"** – [Risk Level]: LOW

PBI Service dataset properties error message, "We are unable to locate the file on OneDrive for Business. Please check that the file exists in this location."

**Work Around**

Firstly, be careful when editing SharePoint files, do not Cut/Paste a pbix to update the main file, this could change the SharePoint file id, breaking the upload connection in PBI workspace, and breaking your version history in SharePoint. However, Copy/Paste to update a file works just fine for version control files.

Secondly, to fix the issue if it does happen, you are able to use the SharePoint Recycle Bin to restore the file. The version history will remain in tact, and the PBI dataset/report will continue working now that the correct file is restored. Preferably though, we do not have to encounter these work-arounds. Do not Cut/Paste a PBIX file to update a versioned file. If you cannot restore the file in SharePoint, delete the broken PBI dataset and re-upload the PBIX from SharePoint to PBI Workspace. Also Cut/Paste a PBIX file could break your version history. However,

The screenshot shows an Outlook email from Microsoft Power BI with the subject "Test\_Pay55.pbix OneDrive refresh disabled". The email body states: "OneDrive refresh for Test\_Pay55.pbix has been disabled. Next refresh for Test\_Pay55.pbix is scheduled for October 12, 2023 22:41 UTC." Below the email, the Power BI Datasets tab is open, showing a list of datasets. The "Test\_Pay55" dataset is highlighted. A "Refresh history" dialog box is open, showing a table of refresh attempts. The table has columns: Details, Type, Start, End, Status, and Message. The first four rows show "Failed" status with messages like "We are unable to locate the file on OneDrive for Business. Please check that the file exists in this location." The fifth row shows "Failed" with the message "An unknown error has occurred. Please try again. If the issue continues, please contact support." A red arrow points from the error message in the email to the "Refresh history" dialog box. Three red boxes with white text provide instructions: "ERROR: We are unable to locate the file on OneDrive for Business. Please check that the file exists in this location.", "FIX: Deleted the PBI dataset, and re-upload the PBIX from SharePoint to PBI Workspace.", and "CAUSE: This issue likely was created by doing something incorrectly to SharePoint to the file, such as Cut/Paste from another file to the Checked out file. This could change the SharePoint file id."

| Details              | Type      | Start                  | End                    | Status | Message                                                                                                        |
|----------------------|-----------|------------------------|------------------------|--------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <a href="#">Show</a> | Scheduled | 10/12/2023, 5:41:05 PM | 10/12/2023, 5:41:07 PM | Failed | We are unable to locate the file on OneDrive for Business. Please check that the file exists in this location. |
| <a href="#">Show</a> | Scheduled | 10/12/2023, 5:32:02 PM | 10/12/2023, 5:32:04 PM | Failed | We are unable to locate the file on OneDrive for Business. Please check that the file exists in this location. |
| <a href="#">Show</a> | Scheduled | 10/12/2023, 5:16:17 PM | 10/12/2023, 5:16:20 PM | Failed | We are unable to locate the file on OneDrive for Business. Please check that the file exists in this location. |
| <a href="#">Show</a> | Scheduled | 10/11/2023, 9:26:02 PM | 10/11/2023, 9:26:21 PM | Failed | An unknown error has occurred. Please try again. If the issue continues, please contact support.               |

**One-Time Upload** – [Risk Level]: NO RISK

The file must be uploaded manually the first time. It does not automatically get added to the Power BI workspace.

**Work Around**

If the team is aware of and follows HCDW team standards, the developers will know that new reports must be uploaded for the first time to PBI Workspace.

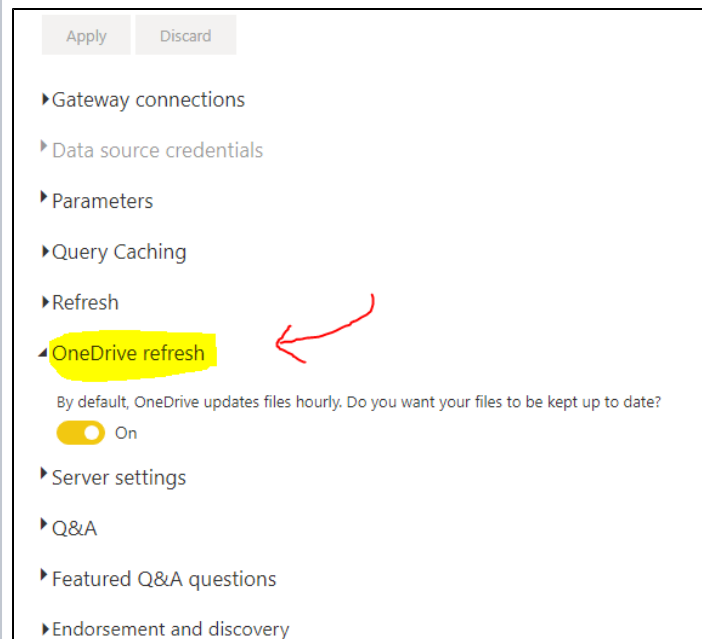
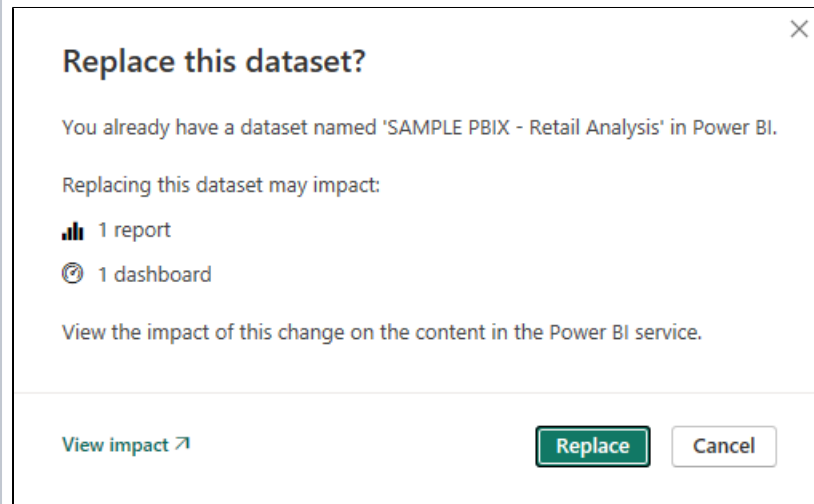


**Wait Time for Workspace Publish** – [Risk Level]: NO RISK

Once the file is saved in SharePoint (i.e., checked in to version control), the reports updates could take up to 10 minutes before you see the changes in the Power BI workspaces.

**Work Around**

This should not be any major issue. If the developers does want to testing something in the PBI Service immediately without waiting, you can use the PBI Desktop "Publish", and you should be prompted to update the report. If you are not prompted, and it creates a duplicate of the same report, you may need to do some cleanup in the DEV workspace to remove the duplicate. Also, verify the Dataset property for "OneDrive refresh" is turned on.



**Deleted Files in SharePoint are still in PBI Workspace** – [Risk Level]: NO RISK

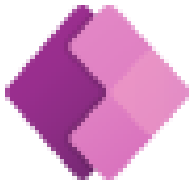
Deleting the PBIX file in SharePoint "Published" folder will not automatically remove the PBI Workspace report.

**Work Around**

After deleting the PBIX file in SharePoint, you must also delete the dataset/report from the PBI Workspace.

## Review: Workspaces

This section shows which workspace the reports will be linked into.

| Setup Complete                          | Version Control App                                                               | Power BI Workspace                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                         |  |                               | <p><b>NOTE: Publish &amp; Deploy</b></p> <p><b>Publish</b> : Is the initial uploaded to a PBI Workspace.</p> <p><b>Deploy</b> : Is deploying content into production environment and managing the lifecycle of organizational content.</p> |
| <input type="checkbox"/> No Content     | VC HCDW Payroll                                                                   | <u>HCDW Payroll [DEV]</u><br> | <p>[DEV] will be automatically synced, changes are published</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>This workspace contains DEV/TEST/PROD environments.</li> <li>TEST/PROD reports are updated with deployment pipeline</li> </ul>     |
| <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> Yes | VC HCDW TDD Models                                                                | <u>HCDW TDD Models</u><br>    | One one workspace, no deployment environments to choose from                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> Yes | VC HCDW Sandbox                                                                   | <u>HCDW Sandbox</u><br>     | One one workspace, no deployment environments to choose from                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> Yes | VC HCDW Team                                                                      | <u>HCDW Team</u><br>        | One one workspace, no deployment environments to choose from                                                                                                                                                                               |
|                                         | ...                                                                               | ...                                                                                                            | ...                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |

## Process: Upload File (One Time Only)



### "SharePoint Upload PBIX" vs. "Publish"

The typical method of publishing a report to PBI Workspace is to choose "Publish" from Power BI Desktop.

The "SharePoint Upload PBIX" method is an alternative means of publishing a PBIX report.

This process is done only once the first time the report is added to Power BI workspace for the first time.

Similarly, after deleting the PBIX file in SharePoint, you must also delete the dataset/report from the PBI Workspace.

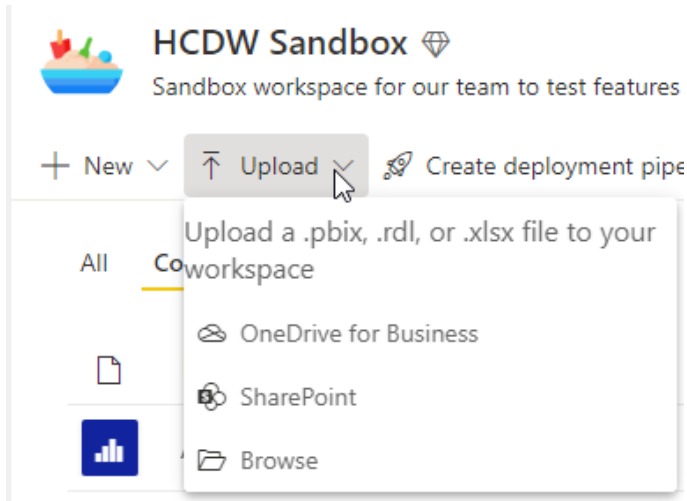
### Steps

1. **In the PBI Workspace:** Upload | SharePoint
2. **Choose the site:** "Power BI Report Site - HCDW PBI"
3. **Choose the VC PBI document library, for example:** "VC HCDW Sandbox"
4. **Open the folder:** "Published Reports"
5. The file will begin uploading, and once complete, it will appear in the workspace
6. Cleanup/Review

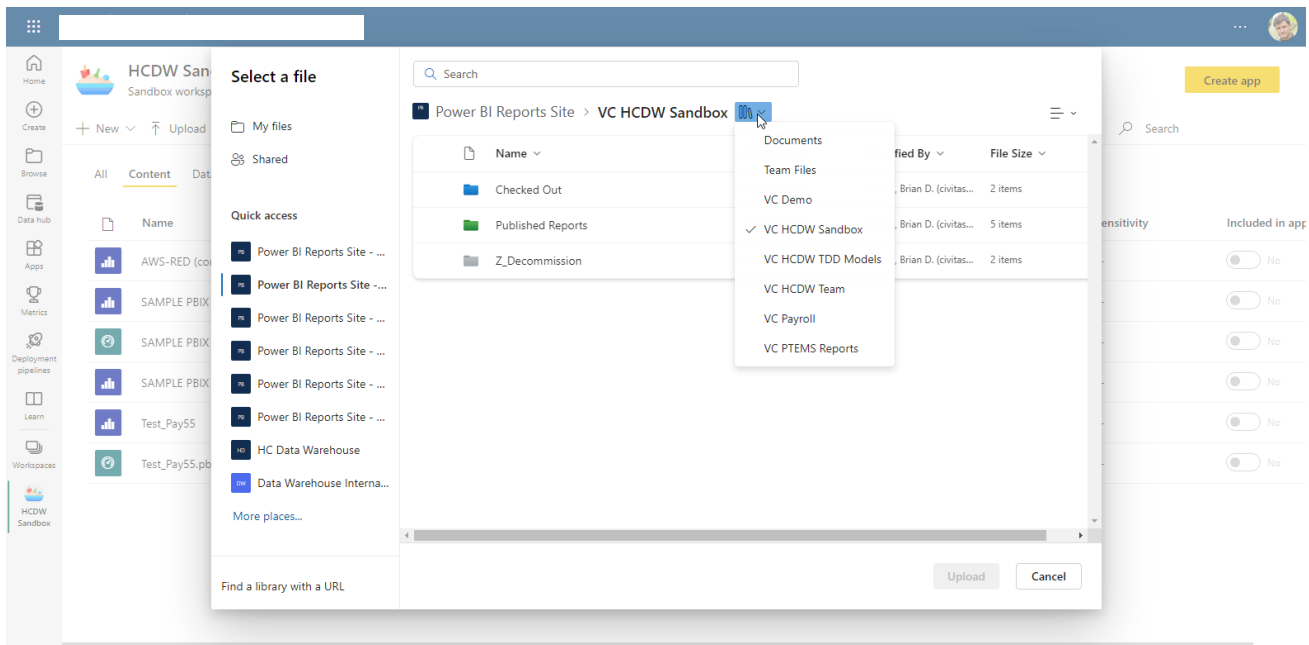
- a. The workspace should contain the Report and Dataset
- b. Sometimes an extra Dashboard file (ending with ".pbix") is also shown in the workspace, You may safely delete this Dashboard content created

### Screenshots

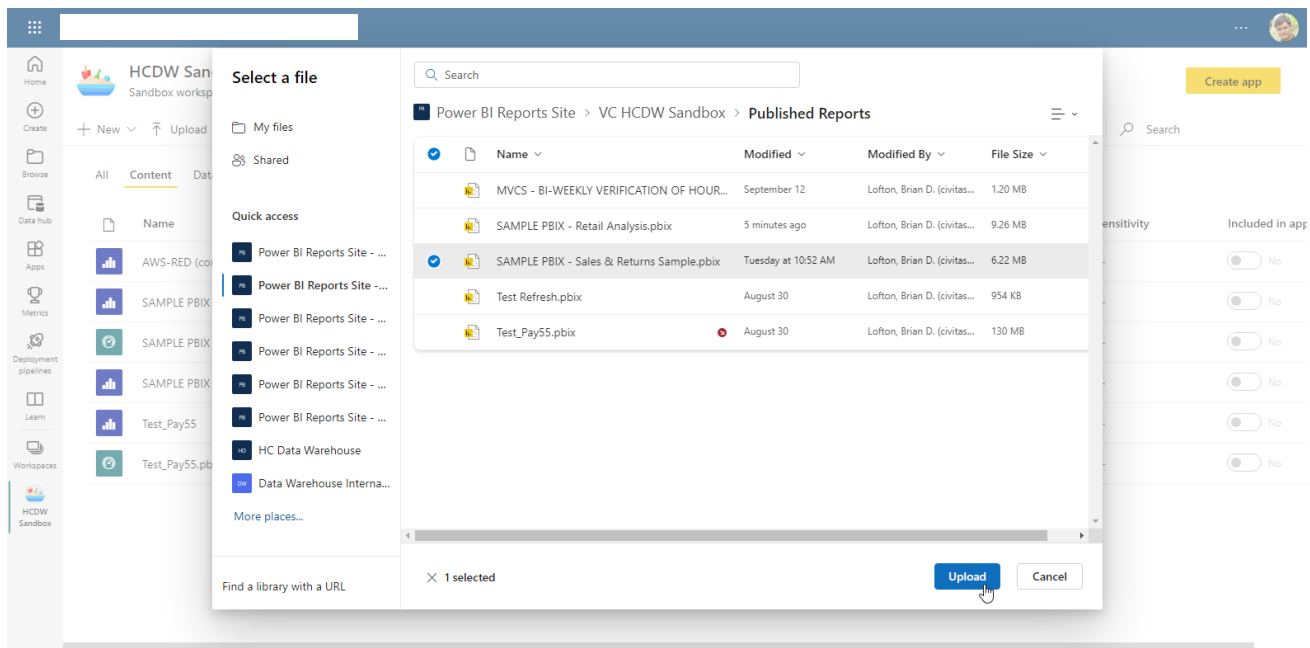
In the PBI Workspace: Upload | SharePoint



Choose the site: "Power BI Report Site - HCDW PBI" | Choose the VC PBI correct document library, for example: "VC HCDW Sandbox"



Open the folder: "Published Reports"



The file will begin uploading, and once complete, it will appear in the workspace

**HCDW Sandbox**  
Sandbox workspace for our team to test features in a sandbox playground environment. In addition, any "Sample" web downloads will be deployed to Sandbox for testing features.

+ New ▾ ↑ Upload ▾ ↗ Create deployment pipeline

View ▾ Filters Settings Access

All Content Datasets + dataflows

| Name                                 | Type   | Owner        | Refreshed            | Next refresh | Endorsement |
|--------------------------------------|--------|--------------|----------------------|--------------|-------------|
| AWS-RED (conn-test)                  | Report | HCDW Sandbox | 8/24/23, 10:00:04 AM | —            | —           |
| AWS-RED (conn-test)                  | Report | HCDW Sandbox | 10/5/23, 1:06:53 PM  | —            | —           |
| SAMPLE PBIX - Retail Analysis        | Report | HCDW Sandbox | 10/5/23, 1:14:11 PM  | —            | —           |
| SAMPLE PBIX - Sales & Returns Sample | Report | HCDW Sandbox | 10/5/23, 12:54:01 PM | —            | —           |
| Test_Pay55                           | Report | HCDW Sandbox | 10/5/23, 12:56:24 PM | —            | —           |

You may safely delete this Dashboard content created, sometimes this shows up after uploading but it can be deleted

| Name                                      | Type      | Owner        | Refreshed            | Next refresh | Endorsement | Sensitivity |
|-------------------------------------------|-----------|--------------|----------------------|--------------|-------------|-------------|
| AWS-RED (conn-test)                       | Report    | HCDW Sandbox | 8/24/23, 10:00:04 AM | —            | —           | —           |
| AWS-RED (conn-test)                       | Report    | HCDW Sandbox | —                    | —            | —           | —           |
| AWS-RED (conn-test).pbix                  | Dashboard | HCDW Sandbox | —                    | —            | —           | —           |
| SAMPLE PBIX - Retail Analysis             | Report    | HCDW Sandbox | —                    | —            | —           | —           |
| SAMPLE PBIX - Retail Analysis.pbix        | Dashboard | HCDW Sandbox | —                    | —            | —           | —           |
| SAMPLE PBIX - Sales & Returns Sample      | Report    | HCDW Sandbox | 10/5/23, 12:54:01 PM | —            | —           | —           |
| SAMPLE PBIX - Sales & Returns Sample.pbix | Dashboard | HCDW Sandbox | —                    | —            | —           | —           |

**Delete dashboard**

Are you sure you want to permanently delete SAMPLE PBIX - Retail Analysis.pbix?

Delete Cancel

Process: Verify Updates Published



### "SharePoint Upload PBIX" vs. "Publish"

The typical method of publishing a report to PBI Workspace is to choose "Publish" from Power BI Desktop.

The "SharePoint Upload PBIX" method is an alternative means of publishing a PBIX report.

After you have modified and check-in changes in Version Control, you may want to verify the changes were published. Here is how.

### Steps

1. The PBI Workspace report should be refreshed just a few minutes after the SharePoint file modified time
2. In the PBI Workspace, check the column "Refreshed" for either the report or dataset
3. In the SharePoint folder, check the "Date modified" property for the PBIX file

### Screenshots

In this example, the report is modified in Power BI at 1:14pm, the SharePoint file was modified at 1:10pm

The screenshot displays the HCDW Sandbox workspace in Power BI. The main table lists several reports, with 'SAMPLE PBIX - Retail Analysis' highlighted. To the right, a file explorer window shows the 'Published Reports' folder, listing files like 'AWS-RED (conn-test).pbix' and 'SAMPLE PBIX - Retail Analysis.pbix' with their respective 'Date modified' timestamps.

| Name                                 | Type   | Owner        | Refreshed            |
|--------------------------------------|--------|--------------|----------------------|
| AWS-RED (conn-test)                  | Report | HCDW Sandbox | 8/24/23, 10:00:04 AM |
| AWS-RED (conn-test)                  | Report | HCDW Sandbox | 10/5/23, 1:06:53 PM  |
| <b>SAMPLE PBIX - Retail Analysis</b> | Report | HCDW Sandbox | 10/5/23, 1:14:11 PM  |
| SAMPLE PBIX - Sales & Returns Sample | Report | HCDW Sandbox | 10/5/23, 12:54:01 PM |
| Test_Pay55                           | Report | HCDW Sandbox | 10/5/23, 12:56:24 PM |

| Name                                      | Status | Date modified      |
|-------------------------------------------|--------|--------------------|
| AWS-RED (conn-test).pbix                  | ✓      | 10/5/2023 1:03 PM  |
| MVCS - BI-WEEKLY VERIFICATION OF ...      | ✓      | 9/12/2023 1:13 PM  |
| <b>SAMPLE PBIX - Retail Analysis.pbix</b> | ✓      | 10/5/2023 1:10 PM  |
| SAMPLE PBIX - Sales & Returns Sampl...    | ✓      | 10/3/2023 10:52 AM |
| Test Refresh.pbix                         | ✓      | 8/30/2023 10:59 AM |
| Test_Pay55.pbix                           | ✓      | 8/30/2023 11:00 AM |

## VIDEO LINKS

### Syncing Published Power BI Report Files Using OneDrive | YouTube - Havens Consulting

Video:

Video Summary:

[YouTube - Havens Consulting](#)

Learn how to easily sync Power BI files (PBIX) between OneDrive and Power BI Workspaces. Allowing updates to the file on OneDrive to automatically sync to the workspace.

## APPENDIX

Online References

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/power-bi/connect-data/refresh-desktop-file-onedrive>

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/power-bi/create-reports/desktop-sharepoint-save-share>

# D) Demo Functionality

## Table of Contents

- [Table of Contents](#)
- [INTRODUCTION](#)
  - [Overview](#)
  - [Links](#)
- [INSTRUCTIONS](#)
  - [Test\\_Pay55.pbix](#)
    - [RESTORE VERSION & VERIFY PUBLISHED CHANGES](#)
    - [PBI VC APP - CHECKOUT & CHECKIN CHANGES](#)

### Version History

| Date       | Version | Description      | Author       |
|------------|---------|------------------|--------------|
| 10/17/2023 | 1.0     | Initial document | Brian Lofton |

## INTRODUCTION

This page contains notes about steps demonstrating the PBI VC APP functionality & features.

### Overview

View Version History

Restore Version History

Review published changes in Power BI (PBI VC changes updated automatically PBI service workspace)

Checkout, Modify, Checkin

Checkout, Modify, Discard

Process: Upload File

### Links

| Link                                                            | "HCDW Sandbox"                                                    | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <a href="#">HCDW Sandbox   PBI VC App</a>                       | <b>HCDW Sandbox   PBI VC App</b>                                  | <b>Front-end application for version control (Power Apps)</b><br><br>This is connected to "Demo" repository. Read below for working on reports in the Project folders live environment. PBI VC app is how files will be edited.                                                                                        |
| <a href="#">HCDW Sandbox - Published   SharePoint Library</a>   | <b>HCDW Sandbox - Published   SharePoint HCDW PBI Reporting</b>   | <b>Back-end file management (Document Library - Published Reports)</b><br><br>New reports will be added directly here for the first time. PBI VC process is how files will be edited after initial upload.                                                                                                             |
| <a href="#">HCDW Sandbox - Checked Out   SharePoint Library</a> | <b>HCDW Sandbox - Checked Out   SharePoint HCDW PBI Reporting</b> | <b>Back-end file management (Document Library - Checked Out)</b><br><br>Version history is only kept with the "Checked Out" file. Use this page to verify PBI VC app has checked out the file with version history. The developer will use Windows file explorer local sync copy, to modify the "Check Out" user file. |

|                                 |                                                         |                                                                                                                                                        |
|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| HCDW Sandbox  <br>PBI Workspace | HCDW Sandbox   PBI<br>Workspace                         | Reports Published (Power BI Workspace)<br><br>New reports will                                                                                         |
| GFE computer                    | File Explorer  <br>SharePoint Sync Local<br>File System | <div>File Explorer: SharePoint Local Files Sync Location</div> <div>C:\Users\%username%\<br/>Reports Site - VC HCDW Sandbox</div> <div>\Power BI</div> |

## INSTRUCTIONS

### Test\_Pay55.pbix

#### **RESTORE VERSION & VERIFY PUBLISHED CHANGES**

##### RESTORE FILE

- View Version History
- Open File (latest version)
- Restore Version History
- Checkout/Add version comments/Checkin -- e.g. "Restore Version: 3.0 (10/12/2023 6:06 PM)"
- Open File (restored version)
- Review published changes in Power BI (PBI VC changes updated automatically PBI service workspace)

#### **PBI VC APP - CHECKOUT & CHECKIN CHANGES**

##### MODIFY FILE

###### Checkout

- Checkout file
- Verify the SharePoint files are updated -- Published Reports ("1" copy created, no version history), Checked Out (version history complete)

###### Modify

- Open file locally
- Modify the file – Change background color, Add textbox notes on the page
- Close & Save the file
- Verify the local file sync is complete (green check)

###### Checkin

- Checkin the file with notes – eg. "CHECKIN: Brian Thu 10/12/2023 17:08 | --- | Change background color, Add textbox notes on the page"
- Verify the PBI VC app has completed the checkin
- Verify the SharePoint files are updated – Published Reports (version history is updated), Checked Out (reports are removed)
- Verify the SharePoint "Published Reports" file version history

##### DISCARD CHECKOUT

###### Checkout

- Checkout file
- Verify the SharePoint files are updated -- Published Reports ("1" copy created, no version history), Checked Out (version history complete)

###### Modify

- Open file locally
- Modify the file – Change background color, Add textbox notes on the page
- Close & Save the file
- Verify the local file sync is complete (green check)

###### Checking (Discard)

- At the Checkin Page, Discard the file



- Verify the SharePoint files are updated – Published Reports (version history is reverted; the checked out modifications are gone), Checked Out (reports are removed)

#### PROCESS: PUBLISH/UPLOAD FILE ( FIRST TIME ONLY)

Upload to PBI Workspace

- Go to PBI Workspace
- Upload File
- Wait, Refresh page, then deleted "Dashboard" ending with "pbix"

---

## VIDEO

Video Link:

[Video Recording](#)

Using the instructions from above, this video demonstrates the the PBI VC app workflow, features, and functionality.

Video:



#### iframe URL

If you have an iframe URL that isn't loading, contact Confluence Admins to request adding the URL to the approved URL list. This is used to keep the site secure.

# Install: HCDW New PBI VC Project

## Table of Contents

- [Table of Contents](#)
- [INTRODUCTION](#)
  - [Overview](#)
  - [Links](#)
- [INSTRUCTIONS](#)
  - [Demo Project Folder](#)
  - [Pre Req: DTC Power App Environment](#)
  - [SharePoint Document Library](#)
  - [App Install & Configuration](#)
  - [Test & Validate](#)
  - [Sharing the App and Flows](#)
  - [Power App solutions - Production environment](#)
- [Appendix](#)
  - [Screenshots](#)
  - [Issue Resolution: Files size limit error \(104MB buffer limit\)](#)
  - [Issue Active: Files size limit error \(104MB buffer limit\)](#)
  - [Issue Resolution: Connection not configured for this service](#)
  - [Excel - Version Control](#)

### Version History

| Date       | Version | Description             | Author       |
|------------|---------|-------------------------|--------------|
| 09/15/2023 | 1.0     | Initial document        | Brian Lofton |
| 10/12/2023 | 2.0     | Appendix section added: | Brian Lofton |

## INTRODUCTION

We create VC Apps that matches to each PBI Workspace project in Power BI. When a new workspace is created a new VC App must be created.

These steps are documented below. For instructions regarding how to use the apps that have been created, those instructions are saved in the Team Training pages, "About PVI VC App".

### Overview

We are going to take the existing app, **PBI VC Demo Folder**, edit it and save it as a new name. For example, if the PBI Workspace is named "Finance" and it needs version control project, we will save the new app named, **VC Finance**.

Additionally we will change out the SharePoint data connection location. For example, we will replace the "Demo folder" with the "Finance folder" in SharePoint (HCDW PBI Reporting, SharePoint site).

We will upload a dummy file for the purpose of testing the check-out/check-in commands.

Lastly, we will need to add permissions to the new VC App for all of the PBI Support Team AD security groups, "secHCDW\_pbiAdmins, secHCDW\_pbiMembers, secHCDW\_pbiViewAll".

### Links

## Corporate Specific Governance Section

| Support Sites                                                                              | Source                                      | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <a href="#">VA Power Platform Center of Excellence (PPCOE)</a>                             | DTC SharePoint                              | Hosted by the Digital Transformation Center (DTC), the PPCOE SharePoint site was created to provide guidance and make information accessible to our business customers about Microsoft's Power Platform premium capabilities, available training resources, success stories, and much more. Enabling the VA with a no-code low-code, citizen developer, cloud-based platform. |
| <a href="#">Power Platform Power Apps - Submit Your Signed Acceptable Use Policy   DTC</a> | DTC SharePoint - Acceptable Use Policy Form | To gain access to the Power Apps environment ( <b>VA PP HCDW Dev</b> ), you must digitally sign and upload the signed <u>Development</u> acceptable use policy document.<br><br><b>Use this PR number: 04306</b>                                                                                                                                                              |

|                                                                                                        |                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| DTC Support Ticket                                                                                     | DTC Support Ticket                       | DTC Support Ticket link                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Power BI Reports Site - DTC Compliance - All Documents (sharepoint.com)                                | HCDW SharePoint - Team Files             | Document for DTC Compliance: Acceptable Use Policy Signature, Emails Communication,                                                                                                                                                       |
| VA Enterprise Microsoft Power Platform Managing Solutions and Environment Deployments - Power Platform | DTC SharePoint - Data Security Documents | This document is intended to be a guide to help move applications or automations currently in a sandbox/development or default environment into a live production environment with Microsoft Power Platform premium capabilities enabled. |

## INSTRUCTIONS



### Online Docs

If at anytime these instructions are incomplete or there are issues, refer to the complete online documentation for this open source solution.

<https://powerbi.tips/2021/02/power-bi-version-control/>

## Demo Project Folder

In the training How to, we will create "VC Demo Folder App Training Test", which will create a new version control environment.

This application is just for testing. All resources created for this exercise will be deleted upon completion of the exercise.

TIP: When creating anew VC project, replace this Demo name with your new project, for example, "VC Finance".

## Corporate Specific Governance Section

### Pre Req: DTC Power App Environment

Access to develop in the Power Platform/Power Apps environment requires access from the DTC (Digital Transformation Center).

Acceptable Use Policy Signature is required for access to Power Apps environment (VA PP HCDW Dev).

Request access to Power Apps environment ('VA PP HCDW Dev')

1. Go to this link: [Power Platform Power Apps - Submit Your Signed Acceptable Use Policy | DTC](#)
2. You will print, complete, physically sign the DEV environment file, named as follows: **VA Enterprise Microsoft Power Apps Acceptable Use Policy - Development.pdf**
3. Scan the signed file into your computer
4. Go to the link (again): [Power Platform Power Apps - Submit Your Signed Acceptable Use Policy | DTC](#)
5. Complete and submit the form.
  - a. Attached your Acceptable Use Policy signed document
  - b. Use this PR number: 04306

Request access follow-up:

1. You may not receive an automated email confirming your submissions.
2. In this event, please send an email, or contact the following individuals, to ensure the request was received
  - a. SUBJECT: Power Apps Environment Request (PR number: 04306)
  - b. TO:

## SharePoint Document Library

Before creating the VC App we first must create a new SharePoint Document Library. This is where the development files are kept, and the app will be connected to.

|   |                                          |                                                                                         |
|---|------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Navigate to SharePoint site, PBI Reports | <a href="https://dvagov.sharepoint.com/sites/">https://dvagov.sharepoint.com/sites/</a> |
|---|------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

|   |                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                |
|---|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2 | On the home page, click New > Document Library, and enter the name: <b>VC Demo Folder App Training Test</b> ,<br>* Note: Naming convention is, ' <u>VC [project name]</u> ' | The document library is created. It will contain no folders at this time.                                      |
| 3 | Create two folders:<br><ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• <b>Checked Out</b></li> <li>• <b>Published Reports</b></li> </ul>                                           | Two folders are created. Make sure the names are exact, otherwise the PBI VC app installation won't find them. |
| 4 | Add a file for testing to the 'Published Reports'                                                                                                                           | Published Reports > <b>New Power BI.pbix</b>                                                                   |

## App Install & Configuration

|    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | Navigate to Power Apps site                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | <a href="https://make.gov.powerapps.us/">https://make.gov.powerapps.us/</a>                                                                                                                                         |
| 2  | Select the correct environment: <b>VA PP HCDW Dev</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | VA PP HCDW Dev                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| 3  | Navigate to the Apps page                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | <a href="https://make.gov.powerapps.us/environments/22cfd6/apps">https://make.gov.powerapps.us/environments/22cfd6/apps</a>                                                                                         |
| 4  | Click ellipse (...) on the <b>PBI VC Demo Folder</b> , and choose 'Edit'                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Tree View page appears (on left)<br>App page preview appears (center)<br>Properties appear (right)                                                                                                                  |
| 5  | At the top right, Choose the save dropdown, and choose 'Save As', and enter your new app name, <b>VC Demo Folder App Training Test</b><br><ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• , if the PBI Workspace is named "<u>Finance</u>" and it needs version control project, we will save the new app named, <b>VC Finance</b>.</li> </ul> | The app is saved, and it is still open for editing                                                                                                                                                                  |
| 6  | In the nave pane (far left), Change the <u>Tree View</u> to the <u>Data</u> pane.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Data Pane opens. Current data sources connections are displayed. For example:<br><ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• RSS</li> <li>• VC Demo Folder (sharepoint)</li> <li>• AppResponse (collection)</li> </ul> |
| 7  | In the Data pane, <b>DELETE</b> the data source, <b>VC Demo Folder (sharepoint)</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | The data source is removed.                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 8  | In the Data pane, choose 'Add data', expand the Connectors, scroll and choose ' <b>SharePoint</b> ' (Note: be careful not to select "SharePoint Sites"). When prompted to choose connect credentials, choose your user account ( <b>user.name@va.gov</b> )                                                                              | A prompt appears to Connect to a SharePoint                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 9  | On the "Connect to a SharePoint" prompt, choose " <b>HCDW PBI Reports</b> " from the Lists choose, the new project folder " <b>VC Demo Folder App Training Test</b> ", choose Connect.                                                                                                                                                  | The data source is added.<br><br>The PBI VC App installation will create the necessary folders.                                                                                                                     |
| 10 | Switch from Data back to the 'Tree View'.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Tree View screen with list of pages: Home Screen, Checkout Screen, ect...                                                                                                                                           |
| 11 | In Tree View click the 'Settings Screen'                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Settings Screen contains a few boxes. They will have red X ( ) by the boxes. We are going to fix the connection to point to the SharePoint.                                                                         |
| 12 | <b>1. Click here to update the items property with the data source</b><br><br>Click this box, then in the formula bar in the top replace the text ' <b>VC Demo Folder</b> ' with the name of the SharePoint document library, ' <b>VC Demo Folder App Training Test</b> '                                                               | Red X will go away, the connection is made successfully                                                                                                                                                             |
| 13 | <b>2. Update the OnSelect Property with the data source in refresh</b><br><br>Click this box and do the same. New value is, <b>Refresh('VC Demo Folder App Training Test')</b>                                                                                                                                                          | Green check ( ) will appear next to the folder names. The connection is made successfully.                                                                                                                          |
| 14 | At the top right, Choose the save dropdown, and choose 'Publish' > choose 'Publish this version'.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | The app is published and ready for testing.                                                                                                                                                                         |
|    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|    | <b>COMPLETE – The app is saved and ready to validate.</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |

## Test & Validate

|   |                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|---|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Navigate to Power Apps site<br>Navigate to the Apps page                        | <a href="https://make.gov.powerapps.us/environments/2:b0185f160fd6/apps">https://make.gov.powerapps.us/environments/2:b0185f160fd6/apps</a>                                                                     |
| 2 | Click on the new app.                                                           | This launches the app.                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| 3 | Use the app to Check-Out, Check-In the sample file:<br><b>New Power BI.pbix</b> | The file should download be checked out and downloaded to your user project folder. <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• <i>PBI Reports - VC Demo Folder App Training\Checked Out\%username%</i></li> </ul> |
|   |                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|   | <b>COMPLETE – The app is validated and ready to share.</b>                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |

## Sharing the App and Flows

|   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                         |
|---|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Navigate to Power Apps site<br>Navigate to the Apps page                                                                                                                                                                           | <a href="https://make.gov.powerapps.us/environments/2:b0185f160fd6/apps">https://make.gov.powerapps.us/environments/2:b0185f160fd6/apps</a>             |
| 2 | Click the ellipse new app (...) and choose 'Share'.                                                                                                                                                                                | Sharing page opens (App sharing)                                                                                                                        |
| 3 | Add permissions to the new VC App for all of the PBI Support Team AD <u>user name</u> or <u>security groups</u> , " <i>secHCDW_pbiAdmins, secHCDW_pbiMembers, secHCDW_pbiViewAll</i> ".                                            | Users are added for sharing                                                                                                                             |
| 4 | Navigate to Power Apps site<br>Navigate to the Flow page                                                                                                                                                                           | <a href="https://make.gov.powerapps.us/environments/2:b0185f160fd6/logicflows">https://make.gov.powerapps.us/environments/2:b0185f160fd6/logicflows</a> |
| 5 | For each of the two flows (titles below), click the ellipse (...) and choose 'Share'.<br><br>* Check In - Power BI Version Control<br>* Check Out - Power BI Version Control                                                       | Sharing page opens (Flow sharing)                                                                                                                       |
| 6 | Add permissions to the new VC App for all of the PBI Support Team AD <u>user name</u> or <u>security groups</u> , " <i>secHCDW_pbiAdmins, secHCDW_pbiMembers, secHCDW_pbiViewAll</i> ".                                            | Users are added for sharing                                                                                                                             |
| 7 | Send the app link to the Development Team, have them favorite the link so they checkout files. Request that they sync the new SharePoint document library locally, so they can easily work on the files locally on their computer. | Users are informed of the new VC application project                                                                                                    |
|   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                         |
|   | <b>COMPLETE – The app is ready to be used for developing solutions within the project.</b>                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                         |

## Power App solutions - Production environment

The DEV environment is for testing features and functionality. To use the Apps in Production, we must work with Power Apps Solutions (create, export, import to Production).

1. Power Apps | DEV Env. | Solutions | "HCDW PBI Version Control".
2. Add existing objects (Flows, Apps, etc.)
3. Export "managed solution"
4. Power Apps | PROD Env. | Solutions | Import

## Appendix

## Screenshots

FIG: The 'Data' pane is where the SharePoint connection is made to the Document Library where the development files are kept.

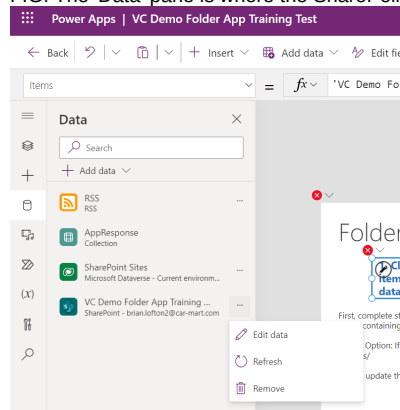


FIG: Before changing the values in 'Settings' screen there are Red X's

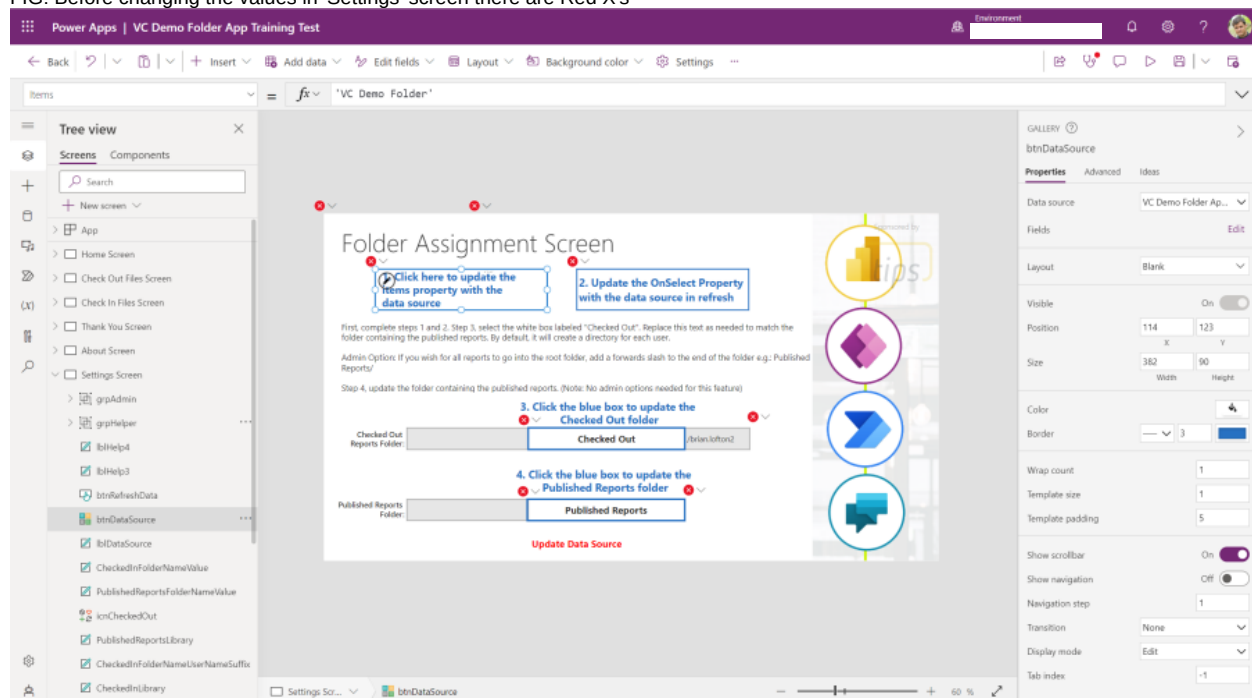


FIG: After changing the values in 'Settings' to use the new SharePoint document library

# Folder Assignment Screen

1. Click here to update the items property with the data source

2. Update the OnSelect Property with the data source in refresh

First, complete steps 1 and 2. Step 3, select the white box labeled "Checked Out". Replace this text as needed to match the folder containing the published reports. By default, it will create a directory for each user.

Admin Option: If you wish for all reports to go into the root folder, add a forwards slash to the end of the folder e.g.: Published Reports/

Step 4, update the folder containing the published reports. (Note: No admin options needed for this feature)

3. Click the blue box to update the Checked Out folder

Checked Out Reports Folder: Demo Folder App Training Test **Checked Out** /brian.lofton2 ✓

4. Click the blue box to update the Published Reports folder

Published Reports Folder: Demo Folder App Training Test **Published Reports** ✓

FIG: The publish button is used once the app configuration is complete.

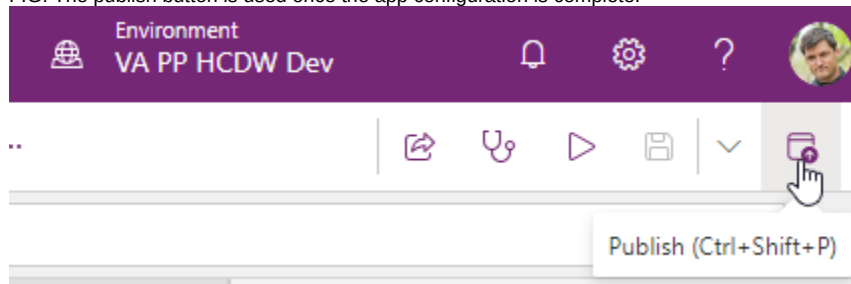
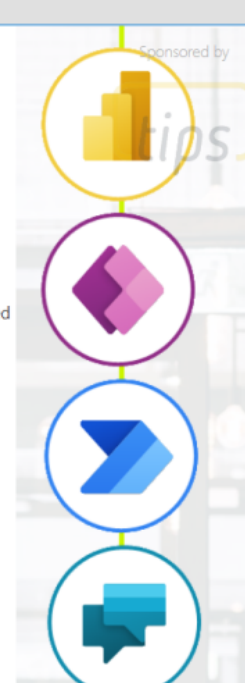


FIG: Adding permissions, Sharing the VC App



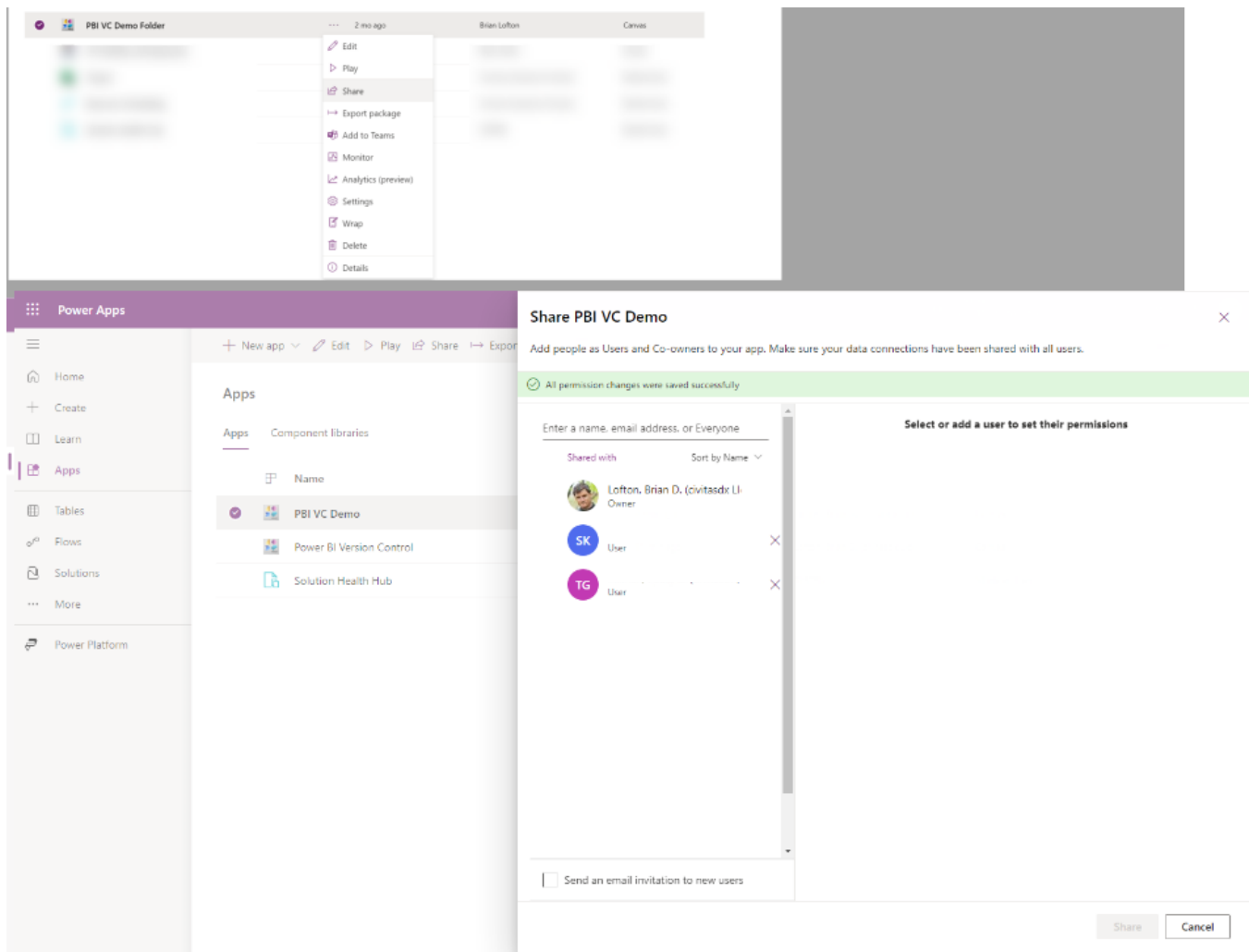


FIG: Power Apps Solutions (create, export, import to Production)



Power Apps

Environment

Search

Back to solutions

HCDW PBI Version Cont...

Overview

Objects

History

Pipelines

Objects

Search

All (3)

Apps (1)

Cards (0)

Chatbots (0)

Cloud flows (2)

Tables (0)

+ New

Add existing

Publish all customizations

...

Solution "Power BI Version Control" imported successfully.

HCDW PBI Version Control > All

| Display name                         | Name                | Type       | Managed | Last Modif...  | Owner        | Status |
|--------------------------------------|---------------------|------------|---------|----------------|--------------|--------|
| Check In - Power BI Version Control  | Check In - Power... | Cloud Flow | No      | 1 hour ago     | Brian Lofton | On     |
| Check Out - Power BI Version Control | Check Out - Pow...  | Cloud Flow | No      | 1 day ago      | Brian Lofton | On     |
| PBI VC Demo                          | hcdw_pbi/vcdem...   | Canvas App | No      | 55 minutes ago | Brian Lofton |        |

+ New

Add existing

Publish all customizations

...

Solution "Pow

AI Model

Successfully.

HCDW PI

App

Automation

Card

Chatbot

Dashboard

Report

Security

Table

More

Canvas app

Model-driven app

Page

**Add existing canvas apps**

Select canvas apps from other solutions or canvas apps that aren't in solutions yet. Adding canvas apps that aren't already in solutions will also add them to Datasource.

☐ Some canvas apps are currently not available to add to solutions. [Learn more](#)

1 canvas app selected

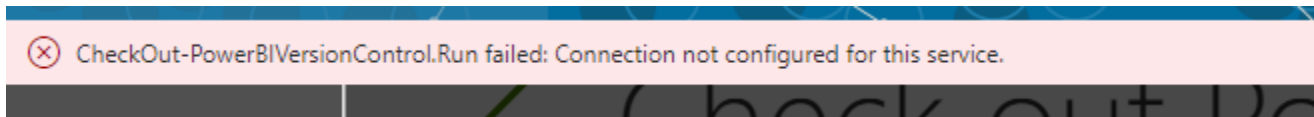
From Datasource   Outside Datasource

| Display name           | Modified | Managed externally? | Status |
|------------------------|----------|---------------------|--------|
| PBI VC Demo            | 1 wk ago |                     | +      |
| PBI VC HCDW Team       | 1 wk ago |                     | +      |
| PBI VC HCDW Dymell     | 1 wk ago |                     | +      |
| PBI VC HCDW TDO Models | 1 wk ago |                     | +      |
| PBI VC HCDW Sandbox    | 1 wk ago |                     | +      |

FIG: Add user access to the flows. Without access user will get the following error during check-out.

ERROR: CheckOut-PowerBIVersionControlRun failed: Connection not configured for this service.

UPDATE 10/13/2023: User access to Power Apps environment and Flows IS NOT REQUIRED; Only access required for PBI VC App is app access (added by HCDW power apps developers/admins).



The top screenshot shows the Power Apps interface for a flow named 'Process mining (pre)'. The '28-day run history' table shows four successful runs. The 'Manage run-only permissions' dialog is open, showing an error: 'Sharing with this AAD user failed because auto-creation of the user failed. Please manually create the user in Dataverse and try again.' A red arrow points to the 'Enter names or email addresses' field. Another red arrow points to the 'Currently shared with' section, which lists 'Pi' and 'Pe'. A red box on the right says 'Access NOT provided, - ERROR: "Sharing failed"'. Another red box on the right says 'Power Platform access provided to environment: - VA PP HCDW Dev'.

The bottom screenshot shows the Power Platform admin center. The 'Users' page is displayed, showing a list of users. The 'Username' column is highlighted in yellow. The 'Main phone' column shows '(202) 702-3445'. The 'Business unit' column is empty. The 'Name' column is also highlighted in yellow.

## Issue Resolution: Files size limit error (104MB buffer limit)

### #1 - Automate flows to use "Move Files"

In Power Apps DEV environment, We have revised the automate flows to use "Move Files" action (replaced flow actions: "Update File" and "Get File Contents")

Other flows modifications were required as well, to accommodate the move file process.

### #2 - Updated the Power App Check Out button

We updated the Power App to send output more information to Check Out button. And to the Checkout Flow, we also added an Input from Power Apps action (PublishedReportsFolder\_Value).

Using "Checked Out" flow, we are now required to create a copy in the Published folder, and this requires extra parameter to in the function to pass the named of Published folder (**PublishedReportsFolder.Text**).

#### Power App Checked Out - Button Update

```
UpdateContext({startTimer:true});
Clear(AppResponse);
Collect(AppResponse,
ForAll(
    Filter(
        GalleryReportsOut.AllItems,
        tglCheckOut.Value = true
    ),
    'CheckOut-PowerBIVersionControl'.Run(
        CheckedOutFolderName.Text,
        Identifier,
        ID,
        ShaePointSiteName.Text,
        PublishedReportsLibrary.Text,
        'File name with extension',
        PublishedReportsFolder.Text
    )
));
```

### Issue Active: Files size limit error (104MB buffer limit)



#### Warning

If a Flow Task solution cannot be identified to increase the files from 104MB buffer limit, then we may have to have alternative solution:

Possible Alternatives:

- Develop the datasets (models) separately from the reports (visuals)– See also: "[Public preview of the TMDL \(pronounced 'tim-dul', Tabular Model Definition Language\)](#)"
- Row-Limit filter during development to reduce data size (process must be identified/documented)

**Reports with large or massive data size get an error with PBI VC app (PBIX file size > 104MB).**

Http request failed as there is an error: 'Cannot write more bytes to the buffer than the configured maximum buffer size: 104857600 (104MB)'.

The 'Check Out' works just fine. But there is a step at the 'Check-In' that causes the error.

## 518MB file vs 104MB buffer limit

The 'Check In' step requires an UPDATE action to preserve the SharePoint ID, this requires an action to get file content-- Flow action: 'Get Checked Out file content'-- and this step errors because of 151 MB report files and lower limit 104MB for buffer size limit. The error happens before the update file action.

We need to determine how to handle large Power BI files and versioning. If a Flow Task solution cannot be identified to increase the files from 104MB buffer limit, then we may have to develop the datasets (models) separately from the reports (visuals).

A screenshot of a Power Apps application window. The title bar at the top is purple and contains the text "Power Apps | PBI VC HCDW Sandbox". On the right side of the title bar are icons for "Share", a list, a refresh, and a help icon. The main content area is white and displays a message: "The following files have had errors:" followed by "Test\_Pay55.pbix". To the right of the text is a green circular icon containing a white house symbol, which typically represents a home or a specific file location in Power Apps.

## The screenshot displays the Microsoft Power Apps Studio environment. On the left, there's a navigation pane with icons for Home, Canvas, Layout, Data, Media, Pages, Integrations, and Power Platform. The main workspace shows a canvas app titled "Power BI Reports". At the top, a header bar contains a search icon, the title "Power BI Reports - Canvas App", and user information. Below the header, a flow diagram is visible, starting with a "When selected item is clicked" trigger. This triggers a sequence of steps: "Compare file name with extension" (Yes), "Compare checked in full file Name" (No), "Get Checked In File messages" (Yes), "Add Authentication" (to authenticate the request with a username and password), "Fetch" (to retrieve data from a SharePoint list), and "Check if the Item Checked Out Request" (Yes). Following this, there are three parallel paths: one for "Check if the Item Checked Out Request" (Yes) leading to "Update Checked Out Report No.", another for "Check if the Item Checked Out Request" (No) leading to "Update Checked Out Report No.", and a third for "Check if the Item Checked Out Request" (No) leading to "Update the Item Checked Out Request". Each path ends with a "Display Message" step. A right-hand pane shows "Run Details" for the current app, indicating it was last run at 8:07 PM on 9/16/2023. Below this, there are sections for "Feedback" and "Community". The bottom status bar indicates the app is in "Design" mode.

#### DOCUMENTATION:

Learn > Connectors > SharePoint > get-file-content-using-path

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/connectors/sharepointonline/#get-file-content-using-path>

Azure Logic Apps > logic-apps-handle-large-messages

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/azure/logic-apps/logic-apps-handle-large-messages>

How to overwrite files using the create file action in Power Automate

<https://sharepointstuff.com/2022/04/20/overwrite-files-using-create-file-action/comment-page-1/>

Power Automate > Limits of automated, scheduled, and instant flows

<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/power-automate/limits-and-config#message-size>

#### **IDEAS - RESOLUTION & WORK AROUND: for handling this file size error**

**REST API with Microsoft Flow, or some other free connector in Power Automate that lets to move or copy files.**

[11:42 AM] Weiner, Eric (Deloitte)

You'll have to find a different way to move the files. Perhaps via HTTP: [Moving Files with SharePoint REST APIs in Microsoft Flow.md · GitHub](#)

Here is another option, the video shows moving to an empty folder: [Power Automate How to Move Files Between Folder in SharePoint Online | YouTube - Lernen Tech](#)

**Develop the datasets (models) separately from the reports (visuals)**

See also: "Public preview of the TMDL (pronounced 'tim-dul', Tabular Model Definition Language)"

**Row-Limit filter during development to reduce data size**

Process must be identified/documented, this could be cumbersome and difficult to follow

## Issue Resolution: Connection not configured for this service

**ERROR: CheckOut-PowerBIVersionControlRun failed: Connection not configured for this service.**

FIX: 10/3/2023

- Remove/Add Power Automate Flows
- Save & Publish the App
  - **COMMENT:** Remove/Add Power Automate Flows-- Fix user permission error
- This resets a schema issue to correct the flow connections

DTC Customer Support Case: 10878795

SUPPORT: Ve <

TITE: Power App error message for user - Connection not configured for this service.

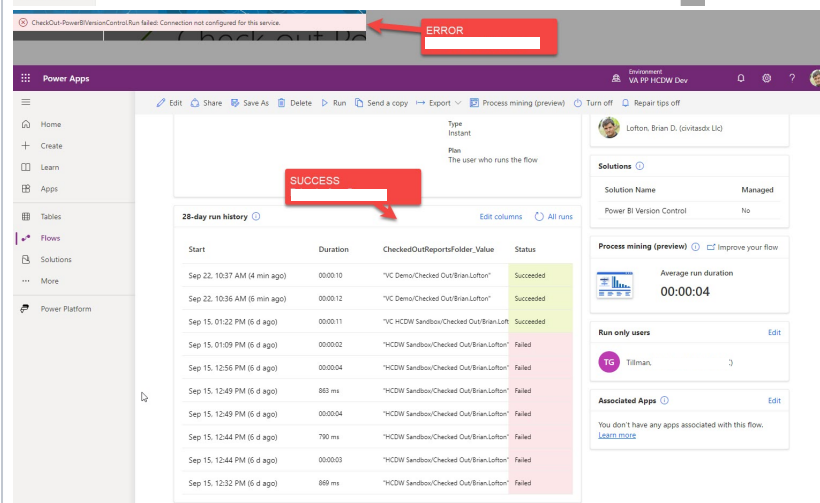
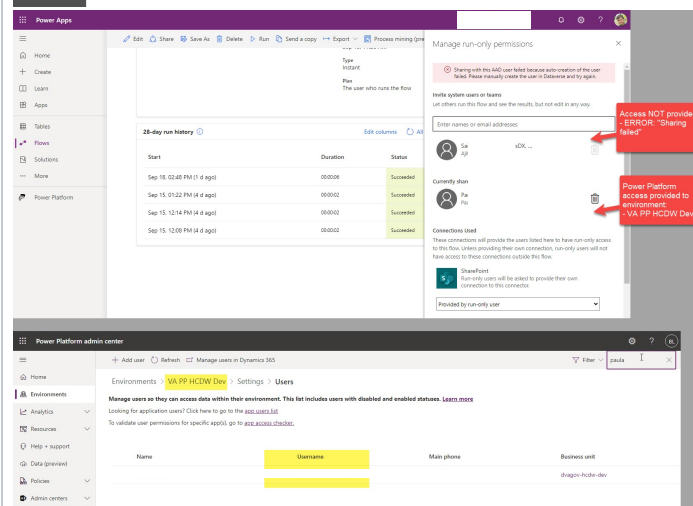
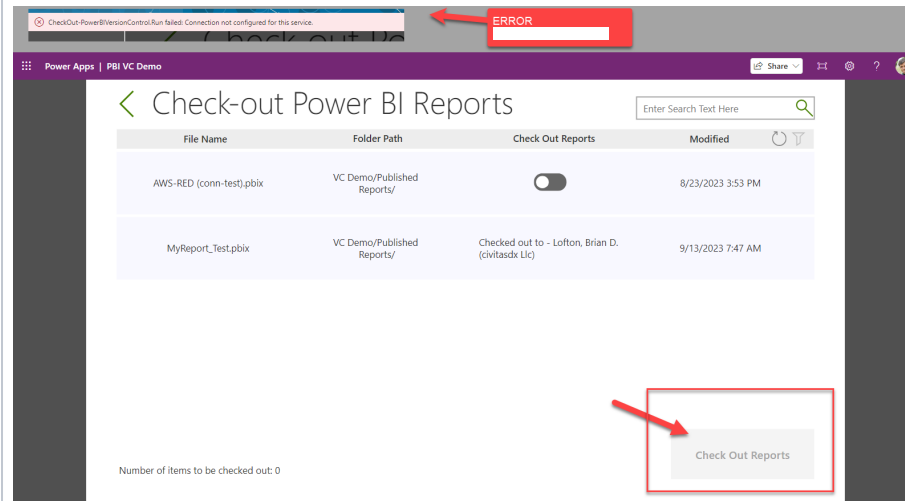
We have just installed/configured a Power App. It works for the app owner ( ). The first testing users gets this error. The user has been added to the Power App Environment.

They press a button in the app, which calls a flow. Then an error message pops up.

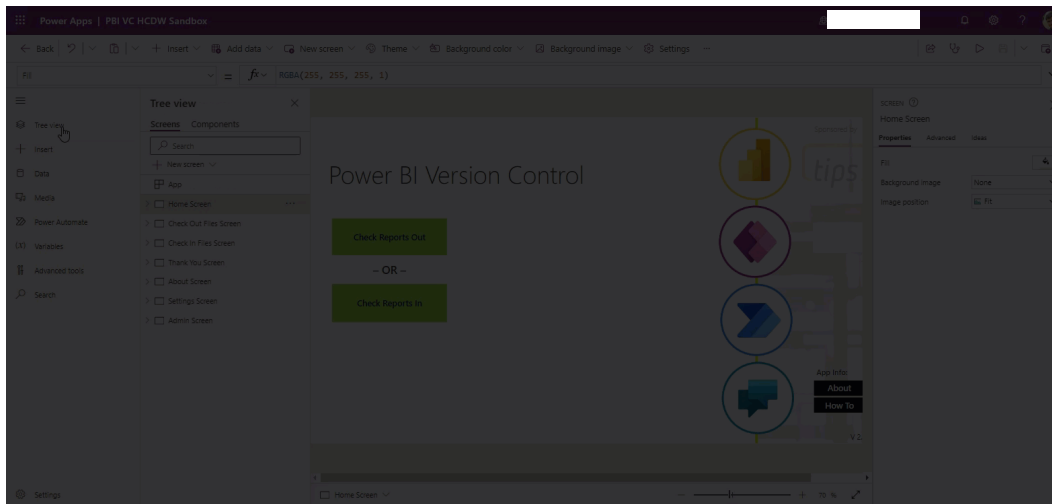
Environment: VA PP HCDW Dev

App Name: PBI VC Demo

Flow: Check Out - Power BI Version Control



Fix Image



## Excel - Version Control

The PBI Version Control app by default works with PBI files only.  
The app can be modified to work with Excel files (this is how).

**"Check Out Files Screen", select the table object 'GalleryReportsOut', replace with this code**

### "Check Out Files Screen"

```

If(
    !filterGallery,
    Filter(
        btnDataSource.AllItems,
        'Folder path' = PublishedReportsFolder.Text & "/" && txtSearchOut.Text in 'File name with extension',
        Right( 'File name with extension',
            5 ) = ".pbix"
            || Right( 'File name with extension',
            5 ) = ".pbix"
            || Right( 'File name with extension',
            5 ) = ".xlsx"
        ),
    Filter(
        btnDataSource.AllItems,
        'Folder path' = PublishedReportsFolder.Text & "/" && txtSearchOut.Text in 'File name with extension',
        Right( 'File name with extension',
            5 ) = ".pbix"
            || Right( 'File name with extension',
            5 ) = ".pbix"
            || Right( 'File name with extension',
            5 ) = ".xlsx",
        'Checked Out To'.DisplayName = User().FullName
    )
)

```

**"Check In Files Screen", select the table object 'GalleryCheckInReports', replace with this code**



**“Check In Files Screen”**

```
If(
    !filterGallery,
    Filter(
        btnDataSource.AllItems,
        'Folder path' = CheckedOutFolderName.Text & "/" && txtSearchIn.Text in 'File name with extension',
        Right( 'File name with extension',
            5 ) = ".pbix"
            || Right( 'File name with extension',
            5 ) = ".pbix"
            || Right( 'File name with extension',
            5 ) = ".xlsx"
        ),
    Filter(
        btnDataSource.AllItems,
        'Folder path' = CheckedOutFolderName.Text & "/" && txtSearchIn.Text in 'File name with
extension',
        Right( 'File name with extension',
            5 ) = ".pbix"
            || Right( 'File name with extension',
            5 ) = ".pbix"
            || Right( 'File name with extension',
            5 ) = ".xlsx",
        'Checked Out To'.DisplayName = User().FullName
    )
)
```